The other screen you'll want to use quite often is the console (figure 1.12), which allows you to write and run JavaScript code right on your web page.

The examples in this book use Google Chrome and its developer console, but you could use Safari's developer tools or Firebug in Firefox, or whatever developer console you're most comfortable with. You can see and manipulate DOM elements such as `<div>` or `<body>` by clicking on the element inspector or looking at the DOM as represented in HTML. You can click one of these elements and change its appearance by modifying it in the console.

You can even delete elements in the console. Give it a try: select the div either in the DOM or visually, and press Delete. Now your web page is very lonely. Press Refresh so that your page reloads the HTML and your div comes back. You can adjust the size and color of your div by adding new styles or changing the existing one, so you can increase the width of the border and make it dashed by changing the border style to Black 5px Dashed. You can add content to the div in the form of other elements, or you can add text by right-clicking on the element and selecting Edit as HTML, as shown in figures 1.13 and 1.14.

You can then write whatever you'd like in between the opening and closing HTML.

Any changes you make, regardless of whether they're well structured or not, will be reflected on the web page. In figure 1.15 you see the results of modifying the HTML, which is rendered immediately on your page.

In this way, you could slowly and painstakingly create a web page in the console. We're not going to do that. Instead, we'll use D3 to create elements on the fly with size, position, shape, and content based on our data.

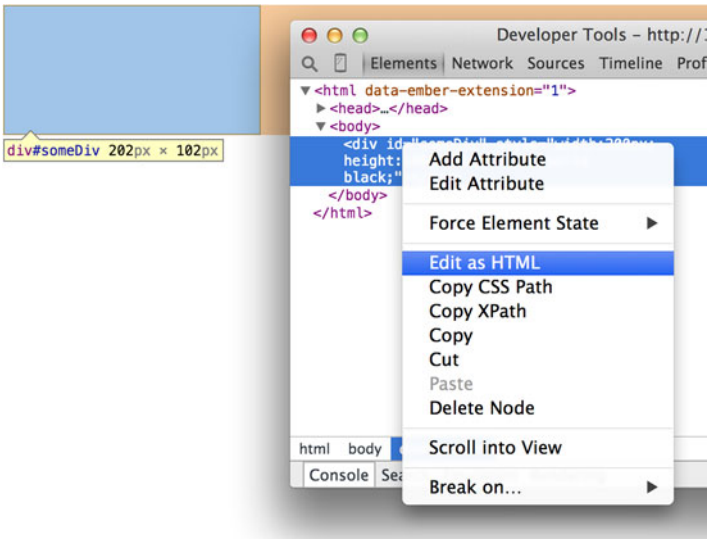


Figure 1.13 Rather than adding or modifying individual styles and attributes, you have the ability to rewrite the HTML code as you would in a text editor. As with any changes, these only last until you reload the page.